

User Manual: Township Fix-It — Westenburg, Polokwane

1. Welcome

Township Fix-It is a mobile-first community web app designed specifically for Westenburg residents to report municipal service faults quickly and track their progress publicly until they are fixed. This app addresses the common problems of lost reports, lack of accountability, and no feedback that residents face when using WhatsApp groups for reporting.

2. What Is Township Fix-It?

Fast Reporting: Report faults like broken streetlights, potholes, burst pipes, and uncollected refuse in about 30 seconds.

Track Progress: Follow every report's status from "Reported" to "In Progress" to "Fixed" with a visible "days open" counter.

Photo Evidence: Attach photos directly from your phone camera as proof.

Location Capture: Use GPS to attach exact coordinates when no clear street address is available.

Search & Filter: Easily find reports by status, fault type, or street keyword.

Export Data: Download all reports as a CSV spreadsheet to provide a paper trail for municipal offices.

3. Why Use This App?

Westenburg residents traditionally report faults in WhatsApp groups, which have three main problems:

1. Messages disappear quickly: Reports get lost as conversations scroll.
2. No counting of reports: The municipality cannot see how many times a fault has been reported.
3. No accountability: There is no record of when a fault was first reported, so issues remain unresolved for long periods.

Township Fix-It solves these by providing a **public, timestamped record** of faults that anyone can view and support.

4. Getting Started: How to Use the App

4.1 Reporting a Fault

1. Open the app and go to the Report a Fault section.
2. Fill in the required details:
 - Fault Type: Select from categories like streetlight, pothole, pipe, refuse, etc.
 - Location: Enter the street name or use the GPS button to capture your exact coordinates.
 - Description: Briefly describe the problem.
 - Photo (Optional): Take or upload a photo as evidence.
 - Your Name (Optional): Provide your name if you want follow-up.
3. Submit your report. It will immediately appear in the public list for others to see.

4.2 Browsing and Supporting Reports

Visit the Browse Reports page to see all faults reported by the community. Use filters to narrow down by status, fault type, or street name. Click on any report to view full details, including photos, location, date reported, and how many days it has been open. Show your support by clicking Support on reports that matter to you.

4.3 Tracking Progress

Each report moves through three statuses:

- Reported (newly submitted)
- In Progress (being addressed by the municipality)
- Fixed (resolved)

The app displays how many days a fault has been open, helping residents and officials prioritize long-standing issues. The dashboard highlights the longest unresolved fault in the township.

4.4 Exporting Reports

You can download all reports as a CSV file to hand over to municipal offices as official evidence of community issues.

5. Tips for Effective Use

- Be as specific as possible with location details.
- Attach photos whenever you can to provide clear proof.

Use the GPS feature for faults without clear street addresses.
Check the app regularly to stay updated on progress and new reports.
Encourage neighbors to use the app to strengthen community voice.

6. Accessibility Features

Semantic HTML landmarks for easy navigation.
Keyboard-friendly with visible focus indicators.
Proper labels and ARIA attributes for screen readers.
Live status announcements for submissions and GPS actions.
High contrast and large buttons for easy use on mobile devices.
Reduced motion and print-friendly styles supported.

7. Privacy and Data Security

All data is stored locally on your device in your browser's storage.
No data, including photos, names, or GPS coordinates, is sent to any server.
You can report anonymously by leaving the name field blank.

8. Technical Details (For Advanced Users)

Built with pure HTML, CSS, and JavaScript — no frameworks or backend.
Uses `localStorage` for data persistence with error handling for storage limits.
Photos are resized client-side to fit storage constraints.
One delegated event listener manages report interactions efficiently.
Geolocation requires serving the app via HTTPS or localhost.

9. Known Limitations and Future Plans

Currently, reports are stored per device and not shared between residents.
CSV export acts as a manual bridge for sharing data with the municipality.
Future improvements may include a shared backend, interactive maps, and municipal reference numbers once official collaboration begins.

10. Team Behind Township Fix-It

Member	Role	Responsibility
Monica Semenya	Project Manager	Timelines, task board, community survey
Grace Mathapo	UX/UI Designer	Wireframes, mobile layout, color and contrast
Caroline Marshall	Frontend Developer	HTML structure, mobile-first CSS
Theo Lefember	JavaScript Developer	Report storage, status workflow, photo & GPS handling, CSV export
All four	Content & Accessibility	Copywriting, alt text, labels, keyboard & contrast checks

11. How to Run the App Locally

1. Open `index.html` directly in a browser for basic use.
2. For GPS features, serve locally with:

```
python3 -m http.server 8000
```

- 3.
 4. Then visit `http://localhost:8000` in your browser.
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12. Support and Feedback

For help or to provide feedback, contact the team via the app's Contact Us form or email [support@yourapp.com].
Join the community forum to discuss issues and improvements.

Thank you for using Township Fix-It! Together, we can make Westenburg a better, more accountable, and connected community.